The Arctic

Technically a frozen desert, the Arctic region is a freezing flat area close to the Arctic Circle in modern day Greenland, Alaska and Canada. It is the homeland of the Aleut and the Inuit who speak a language that originated from the Eskimo-Aleut language family. The population of the Arctic is relatively smaller than other culture regions due to the unwelcoming landscape and those who do live here are spread throughout a vast region. The natives of these lands were nomadic in nature and followed the polar bears, seals and other animals as they travelled throughout the tundra. The Aleut were more settled in the southern regions and had established fishing centers along the coastline.

Both the Aleut and the Inuit shared various customs and practices. Both typically fashioned houses in the shapes of domes made from wood or sod, or from ice in the northern regions. The fur from seals and otters was used to fashion warm and waterproof clothes. They both created elongated open-aired boats and used dogsleds to travel across the land. In 1867, after the United States bought Alaska, the consequences of what the native population had suffered became apparent. Through disease, death and oppression, the Inuit and the Aleut had a population of just 2500 remaining. Today, the descendants of those who survived continue to live in the region.